ALUTA · PRODUCT PLAN

Harmony — "Our Space"

A music-native roadmap for the couple / “Our Space” experience

Prepared for Anesius

Version 1.0 · **Date** 3 October 2026

Status Plan — not yet started

Aluta — Harmony ("Our Space") Product Plan

A music-native roadmap for the couple/bond experience

Prepared for: Anesius · **Version:** 1.0 · **Date:** 3 October 2026 · **Status:** Plan — not yet started

1. Executive summary

Harmony (the couple / "Our Space" surface) should not try to out-feature the generic couple apps (Paired, Cupla, Between, Lovewick). They already own streaks, daily questions and shared calendars. **Aluta's unfair advantage is music plus real-time presence** — a combination none of them can copy. The plan therefore bends every borrowed idea toward that core: the relationship is expressed *through* music and shared listening, and the generic rituals are built *around* that centre rather than beside it.

The guiding philosophy — taken straight from the research and worth protecting — is: **reward the relationship, not app-opening.** Couples come back because *something between the two of them* is waiting, not because the app exploits endless scrolling or variable-reward notifications.

This document turns the idea list into an actionable plan: what already exists, the nine features worth building, a detailed spec for each (UX, data model, realtime events, effort), a three-phase roadmap, success metrics that measure relationship health rather than vanity, and the open decisions to settle before coding.

2. Design principles (the guardrails)

1. **Reward the relationship, not the app.** Streaks and progress track *meaningful acts between partners* (answering the question, listening together, writing in the diary, sending a dedication) — never app opens or time-in-app.
2. **No "love score."** Progress is expressed as warm stages ("Growing", "Deeply connected") and memories unlocked — never a number that claims to measure a relationship.
3. **Private by default, both opt-in.** Every shared surface requires both partners; nothing broadcasts without consent. Reuse the per-friend audience gate already built for "listening now".
4. **One gentle nudge per ritual.** A dedication, a daily question — a single, meaningful notification. Never engagement bait or streak-panic spam.
5. **Long-distance is a first-class case.** Scheduled synchronized listens, presence, and capsules are designed so distance feels smaller, not larger.
6. **Music is the medium.** When a feature *can* be expressed through a song, it should be. That is the moat.

3. Current state — what Aluta already has

Harmony already ships several of the researched ideas, so these are **not** to be rebuilt:

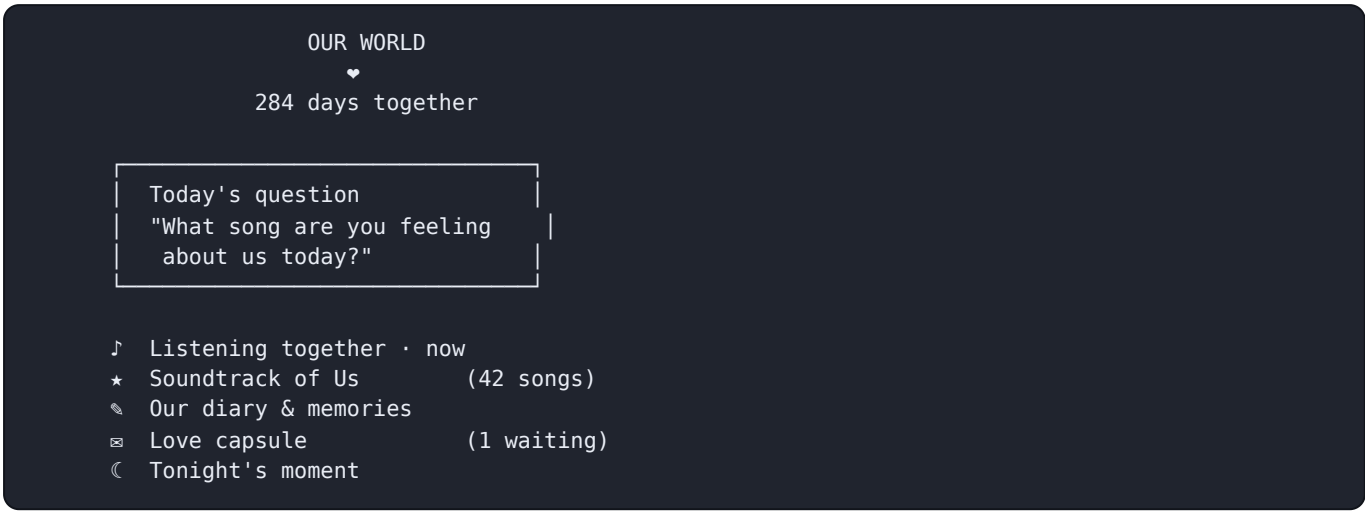
Researched idea	Status in Aluta
#3 Shared memory garden	Partially — shared diary / "Our Space" timeline
#8 Presence	Yes — "listening now" presence with per-friend privacy audience
#9 Couple music room	Largely — "listen together" (synced playback), send a song, "reminds me of you"
Bonds / private circles	Yes
Stories / status	Yes

Implication: the highest-leverage *new* work is the music-native versions of the remaining ideas — the streak (#1), the daily question (#2), mood sync (#5), the monthly recap (#10) — plus the connective tissue: **Soundtrack of Us** and the **"Our World" hub**.

---

4. The vision — "Our World"

Entering Harmony should not feel like a social feed. It should feel like walking into a private room the two of them share. One hub screen, music-first:



The **now-listening presence is the hero**, because that is what only Aluta can do. Everything else hangs off it.

---

5. Feature catalogue

Each feature below lists: **what it is**, **why it matters**, the **UX flow**, a **data model** sketch, the **realtime/backend** needed, **edge cases**, and a rough **effort** (S / M / L).

5.1 Soundtrack of Us ⭐ (centerpiece)

What. A single living playlist owned by the couple that auto-grows from the songs that already pass between them.

Why. This is the memory garden — but through music, which is far stickier for a music app. It becomes the artefact that is *waiting* for them and the reason to return.

Sources that add a track (automatically or with one tap):

- A song shared with "reminds me of you".
- A song played during a listen-together session (offered, not forced).
- The two picks from a music daily-question (§5.4).
- Manual "add to Soundtrack" from any now-playing screen.

Each entry can carry: a one-line memory ("playing the night we…"), who added it, and the date.

UX. A dedicated tab in the hub: album-style grid / list, newest first, each row playable and long-press-to-annotate. A gentle empty state ("Your first song together starts the soundtrack").

Data model.

```
couple_soundtrack(
  id, couple_id, track_ref (song id / url / metadata),
  added_by_user_id, source ENUM(share|listen_together|question|manual),
  memo TEXT NULL, created_at )
```

`couple_id` = a stable key for the bond (sorted pair of user ids, or the existing bond id).

Backend / realtime. REST add/list/remove; a WS `soundtrack_added` event so the partner's hub updates live. Reuse existing song-metadata plumbing.

Edge cases. De-dupe same track; allow remove (either partner); respect privacy (couple-private only).

Effort: M. Builds directly on existing song-share + diary storage.

5.2 Daily "Us" question (with a music variant)

What. One prompt per day shown to both; each answers privately; answers reveal **simultaneously**.

Why. The cheapest, highest-retention ritual in the whole category — and it feeds the centerpiece.

Two prompt types, mixed:

- *Text:* "What made you smile today?" · "What do you miss about me right now?"
- *Music:* "Pick a song for how you feel about us today." → both picks drop into **Soundtrack of Us**.

UX. A card on the hub. After you answer, it shows "Waiting for …". When both have answered, both get a single gentle nudge and the card flips to reveal both answers side by side. A small archive of past questions.

Data model.

```
daily_prompt(id, date, kind ENUM(text|music), body)
prompt_answer(id, prompt_id, couple_id, user_id,
              answer_text NULL, track_ref NULL, created_at,
              revealed BOOL)
```

Backend / realtime. A prompt-of-the-day source (curated list, rotated). WS `prompt_answered` → when both present, emit `prompt_revealed` to both (same simultaneous-reveal pattern reused by Mood Sync).

Edge cases. Time-zone fairness for "today"; one answer per partner per day; grace if only one answers (reveal next day or on nudge).

Effort: M.

5.3 Dedications — a song as a feeling

What. An upgrade to "send a song": attach a **mood** and a short **voice note**, delivered as an *event*.

Why. Turns a silent share into a moment. "You have a dedication" → opening it plays the song with your note.

UX. From any now-playing / song row: *Dedicate* → pick partner (in a bond), optional mood chip, optional ≤15s voice note, optional line. Partner receives a distinct inbox item + one nudge; opening plays song + note; it auto-adds to Soundtrack of Us with the memo.

Data model.

```
dedication(id, couple_id, from_user_id, track_ref,
           mood TEXT NULL, voice_note_url NULL, note TEXT NULL,
           created_at, opened_at NULL)
```

Backend / realtime. Reuse voice-note recording/upload already in chat; WS `dedication_received`.

Effort: S–M (mostly a richer wrapper over existing song-share + voice notes).

5.4 Mood Sync → a musical remedy

What. Both pick a current mood **blind**; then reveal. On a mismatch, the app offers an *action*, not just an observation.

Why. Converts an emotional insight into a shared moment instead of leaving it hanging.

UX. A hub tile "How are we feeling?" → pick a mood (emoji + label). When both have set today's mood → reveal: *You ❤ feeling loved · Partner ☹ missing you.* Then a contextual suggestion: **Play this together** (a comfort song), **Start a listen-together**, or **Send a voice note / dedication**.

Data model.

```
mood_entry(id, couple_id, user_id, date, mood, created_at, revealed BOOL)
```

Backend / realtime. Same simultaneous-reveal pattern as the daily question. Suggestion logic is a simple local rule table (mismatch → remedy).

Effort: S–M (shares the reveal mechanism with §5.2).

5.5 Love Capsule / scheduled synchronized listen

What. Schedule a song + message to **unlock at a chosen time**. The long-distance power move: a *synchronized* scheduled listen — "let's both press play at 9 PM," the app counts you both in.

Why. Novel, deeply emotional, and uniquely suited to distance. Nobody in the category pairs a time capsule with synchronized playback.

UX. *Create capsule* → pick song (+ optional message / photo), pick unlock time ("Friday 8 PM"). Locked card shows a countdown on both hubs. At unlock: both get a nudge; a "press play together" screen counts down 3-2-1 and starts synchronized playback (reuse listen-together), with live reactions (§5.6).

Data model.

```
love_capsule(id, couple_id, created_by, track_ref,
             message NULL, media_url NULL,
             unlock_at, mode ENUM(message|sync_listen),
             opened_at NULL)
```

Backend / realtime. A scheduled unlock (server timer / cron) emitting `capsule_unlocked`; sync listen reuses the existing listen-together session.

Edge cases. Both-offline at unlock (hold until next open); cancel/edit before unlock; time-zone display.

Effort: M–L (scheduling + sync choreography).

5.6 Listen-together, richer

What. Three additions to the existing synced playback.

- **Live reactions.** Tap to float a heart / emoji that both see in real time on the now-playing screen — an ephemeral "concert lighter," the feeling of being there together.
- **Save this session.** After a session, offer to save it (the songs + any reactions/messages) as a dated memory on the timeline and into Soundtrack of Us.
- **Shared queue.** Both add to a queue for a planned "listening date."

Why. Deepens the one feature that is already Aluta's strongest differentiator.

Data model. `listen_session(id, couple_id, started_at, ended_at)` + `listen_reaction(session_id, user_id, emoji, at_ms)`; `listen_queue_item(session_id, track_ref, added_by, position)`.

Backend / realtime. WS `listen_reaction` broadcast within the session; session summary persisted on end.

Effort: M.

5.7 "In tune" streak — tied to the player disc styles

What. A streak that counts **meaningful acts** (answered the question, listened together, wrote in the diary, sent a dedication) on a given day — never opens.

Why. Encourages the rituals without becoming manipulative, and — crucially — its rewards cross back into the music product.

Rewards (unlocks, not scores). Milestones unlock couple cosmetics: a shared theme and an exclusive **player disc style / "anniversary vinyl" skin** (reuses the disc-style controller already built). Stages are warm labels: *New → Connected → Growing → Deeply connected → In tune.*

Data model.

```
couple_streak(couple_id, current_days, longest_days, last_active_date)
streak_event(couple_id, date, kind)        -- dedupe per day
couple_unlock(couple_id, kind, unlocked_at) -- theme / disc skin
```

Backend / realtime. Nightly roll-up; unlock hooks into the existing `PlayerStyleController` so a new "anniversary vinyl" appears in the style picker.

Edge cases. A missed day cools (don't punish harshly — e.g., freeze, or a 1-day grace). Never a guilt nudge.

Effort: M.

5.8 Monthly recap = a Mixtape

What. Each month, auto-generate "Our " as a **playable** retrospective, not a stats dashboard: the month's shared songs + photo/diary highlights, as a mixtape you can press play on.

Why. Delight + retention; it makes the accumulated history feel alive and re-livable.

UX. On the 1st, a card appears: "Our September is ready." Opening shows a cover, the month's numbers (songs, photos, messages, moments), and a play button that runs the month's songs with the highlights as a backdrop. Saved to the timeline.

Data model. Mostly derived: a `monthly_recap(couple_id, month, generated_at, cover_ref)` plus queries over soundtrack / diary / sessions for that month.

Effort: M (generation job + a nice player screen).

5.9 "Our World" hub (the home)

What. The home screen of Harmony that ties all of the above together (see §4). Days together · today's question · **now-listening presence (hero)** · Soundtrack of Us · diary/memories · love capsule · tonight's moment (a 2-minute nightly ritual — same song + one line, great for distance).

Why. Gives the section a single, emotionally-anchored home instead of scattered features.

Effort: M — but best built **last**, once the pieces exist to surface.

---

6. Technical architecture notes

The plan is deliberately built on what already exists, to keep it buildable:

- **Couple key.** Introduce a stable `couple_id` (sorted user-pair or the existing bond id) that all new tables hang off.
- **Realtime.** Reuse the existing WebSocket manager and the `now_playing_presence` / listen-together services. A single **simultaneous-reveal** pattern serves the daily question and mood sync; a **broadcast-in-session** pattern serves listen reactions.
- **Storage.** Dedications/capsules reuse the chat voice-note recording + media upload; Soundtrack and recaps reuse the diary store and song-metadata helpers.
- **Scheduling.** Capsule unlock + monthly recap need a server-side timer/cron (the same mechanism can drive both).
- **Cosmetic rewards.** The streak's unlocks plug into the already-built `PlayerStyleController` (the "anniversary vinyl" is just another disc style gated by an unlock flag).
- **Privacy.** Everything couple-scoped and private; reuse the per-friend audience gate.

---

7. Phased roadmap

Phase 1 — The heartbeat (weeks 1–3). Ship the ritual loop that creates reasons to return. - Soundtrack of Us (§5.1) - Daily "Us" question + music variant (§5.2) - Dedications (§5.3)

Phase 2 — Depth & distance (weeks 4–6). - Mood Sync (§5.4) - Love Capsule + scheduled sync listen (§5.5) - Listen-together reactions + save session (§5.6)

Phase 3 — The world & the payoff (weeks 7–9). - "Our World" hub (§5.9) - "In tune" streak + disc-style unlocks (§5.7) - Monthly Mixtape recap (§5.8)

(Durations are indicative for a solo/small build and assume reuse of existing services.)

8. Success metrics (relationship health, not vanity)

Measure whether the *relationship* is being served, not time-in-app:

- **Mutual-act days:** days where *both* partners did a meaningful act (the real signal).
- **Ritual completion:** % of daily questions both answered; dedications sent per week.
- **Soundtrack growth:** songs added per couple per month.
- **Distance value:** scheduled sync listens completed; capsules opened.
- **Returning-together rate:** couples active in Harmony 4+ weeks after pairing.

Explicitly **not** tracked as success: raw session length, notification open-rate, or any single "engagement" number that rewards compulsion.

9. Risks & mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Feeling gimmicky / forced	Keep rituals optional and gentle; one nudge each; warm copy.
Streak guilt / manipulation	Streaks only on meaningful acts; grace day; never guilt nudges.
Asymmetry (one partner engages, one doesn't)	Design for the quiet partner — low-effort taps, dedications that invite without pressure.
Privacy anxiety	Couple-private by default; both opt-in; clear audience controls.
Scope creep	Ship Phase 1 and validate the ritual loop before Phase 2/3.

10. Open decisions (settle before coding)

1. **Couple key:** reuse an existing bond id, or derive a sorted user-pair id? (Affects every table.)
2. **One partner or many bonds?** Is Harmony strictly 1:1, or can a user have more than one bond (sibling, best friend)? The research frames it as couples, but the "bond ya kipekee" wording suggests any special bond — decide scope.

3. **Daily-question source:** curated static list vs. rotating sets vs. seasonal packs.
4. **Notifications:** confirm the "one gentle nudge per ritual" budget and quiet hours.
5. **Anniversary date:** where is "days together" seeded from (pairing date vs. a user-set anniversary)?
6. **Phase-1 cut:** confirm Soundtrack + Daily question + Dedications as the first shippable slice.

Next step: on your go-ahead, I'll turn Phase 1 — starting with Soundtrack of Us — into a concrete implementation plan (tables, API, Flutter screens, and WS events) that drops into the existing diary / presence / listen-together services.